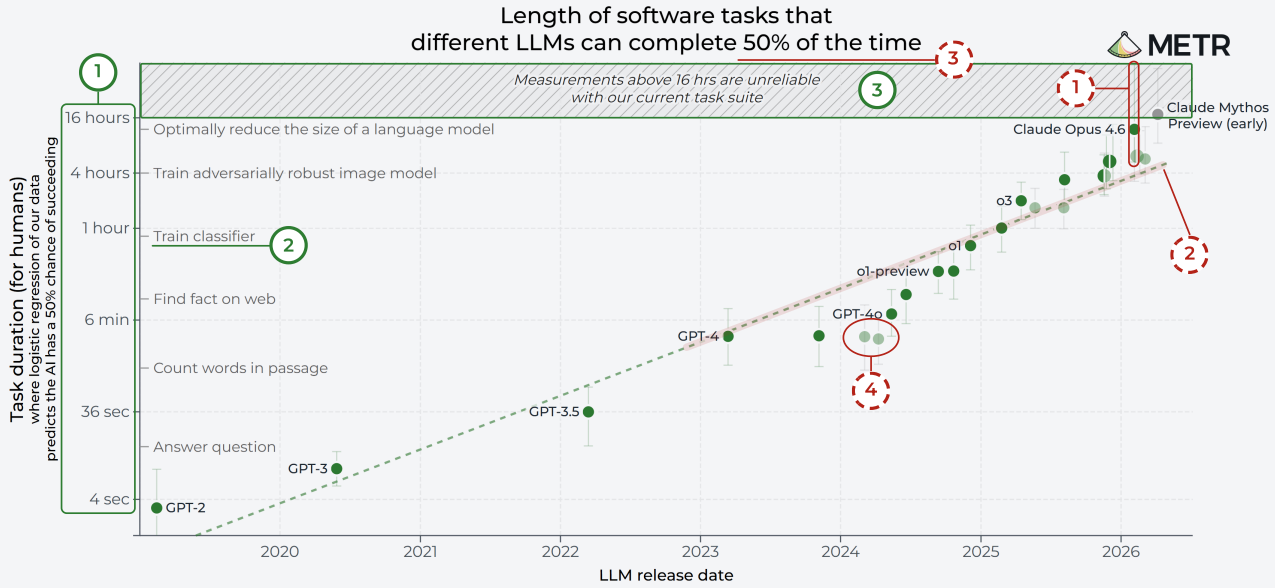
METR's Time Horizon Chart Is Easy to Read, and Easy to Overread

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Original chart | Dataset | METR analysis code



METR, Time Horizon 1.1, 50% success, log scale. Our additions: ○ strength ◌ weakness

Strengths

1. **Log scale makes doubling linear**
   Steady doubling becomes a steady slope, read by position on a common scale, the most accurate channel (L4). Equal ratios get equal distances, as Weber's law suggests (L4).
2. **Example tasks give the axis meaning**
   "Train classifier" near 1 hour maps the physical unit, minutes, onto a conceptual one, kinds of work (data models, L2).
3. **It marks where its data stops**
   Hatching and the gray Mythos dot pop out preattentively (L4), so the chart claims nothing its tasks cannot measure (expressiveness, L2).

Weaknesses

1. **Uncertainty is drawn at 20% opacity**
   Opus 4.6 reads as 12 h; its 95% CI spans 5 to 61 h. Faint whiskers sink into the ground (figure and ground, L5). **Fix:** wide CI bars.
2. **One straight line hides a bend**
   Every model since o3 sits above it. Like Anscombe's quartet (L1), one summary hides structure; continuity (L5) reads one pace. **Fix:** a recent fit.
3. **"50%" carries the headline**
   At 80%, Opus 4.6 falls from 12 h to 70 min, yet the threshold sits in a rotated label that needs attentive reading (L4). **Fix:** plot both.
4. **Luminance used for a category**
   Frontier or not is nominal, but light green is an ordered channel with no key (expressiveness, L2). Six models are half dots. **Fix:** hue, key, jitter.

Marks

Point	one AI model (26 in all)
Vertical line	95% bootstrap CI
Dashed line	METR's exponential fit
Hatched area	above 16 h
Aa Text	model and task names

Channels

x position	release date	Q interval
y position, log	50% horizon (human min)	Q ratio
Whisker length	width of the CI	Q ratio
Luminance	frontier at release or not	N
Gray hue, texture	beyond the 16 h ceiling	N

Our reanalysis

Since o3, every frontier model sits **above** METR's line. A fit from 2024 on doubles every **105 days** (METR: 188).

